



Just like magic, the pygmy shrew zips through the underbrush, barely visible to the naked eye. These tiny creatures are the smallest mammals known to us, weighing less than a dime and being only about the size of your thumb. Their fur is a soft, velvety brown color, which helps them blend in with their surroundings. They have a pointy snout, tiny eyes, and ears that are almost hidden by their fur.



Remember how we said they're excellent at blending in? Well, that's because they live in places like fields, forests, and gardens all around Europe, North America, and Asia. In their little homes, they feast on a buffet of insects, spiders, and other small invertebrates. In fact, they eat so much that they need to consume 2 to 3 times their body weight in food each day!

Now, imagine eating that much, you'd probably be very sleepy, right? Well, pygmy shrews don't have much time for sleep, they're too busy living their life cycle. They're born in the spring, grow quickly, and by summer, they're ready to have little shrews of their own. Despite their small size, they're fearless, using their sharp teeth to defend themselves from threats.



Speaking of threats, did you know that pygmy shrews have a special trick? Their saliva is venomous, which helps them to paralyze their prey and defend against predators. This makes them different from other shrew species, which can't do this. So, next time you're exploring the great outdoors, remember to respect these small but mighty creatures.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What do pygmy shrews eat?
A. Seeds and nuts
B. Leaves and berries
C. Fish and birds
D. Insects, spiders, and small invertebrates
- 2) Which is a place pygmy shrews might live?
A. Beaches and oceans
B. Fields and forests
C. Deserts and dunes
D. Mountains and caves
- 3) What is special about a pygmy shrew's saliva?
A. It's sweet
B. It's colorless
C. It's always cold
D. It's venomous
- 4) When are pygmy shrews ready to have babies?
A. One season after being born
B. After just a year
C. As soon as they're born
D. One week after being born
- 5) When are pygmy shrews generally born?
A. In the winter
B. In the fall
C. In the spring
D. In the summer
- 6) What is interesting about how much pygmy shrews eat?
A. They eat up to three times their body weight each day.
B. They eat their body weight in food a day.
C. They eat half their body weight per day.
D. They go weeks without eating.
- 7) What sets pygmy shrews apart from other shrew species?
A. Their color
B. Their saliva
C. Their diet
D. Their size
- 8) What color is the fur of a pygmy shrew?
A. Gray
B. Brown
C. Black
D. White
- 9) How do pygmy shrews defend themselves?
A. By releasing a foul smell
B. Using their sharp teeth
C. With their strong muscles
D. Through camouflage
- 10) How big is a pygmy shrew?
A. The size of a hand
B. The size of a cat
C. As big as a mouse
D. The size of your thumb

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "My fur changes color based on the seasons, just like a chameleon."
- 12) "I survive on an all-insect diet, including spiders and other tiny creepy crawlies."
- 13) "Now, let me tell you, we pygmy shrews eat 2 to 3 times our body weight in food every day, that's a lot!"
- 14) "My saliva can paralyze my prey and protect me from predators."
- 15) "We prefer to hang out in the desert, it's nice and warm."
- 16) "We love long sleeps, especially after a big meal."





- 46) Because they're so small, they've got to be careful of predators.
A. they have B. they had
C. they were D. they are
- 47) They're so tiny that it's hard to see them in the grass.
A. They have B. They were
C. They are D. They do

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 48) Pygmy shrews are known for their high metabolism, requiring them to eat almost their own body weight in food every day.
- 49) Can pygmy shrews swim?
- 50) Pygmy shrews are active hunters, constantly searching for insects and small invertebrates to eat.
- 51) Pygmy shrews have a short lifespan of only about 1 to 2 years.
- 52) Are pygmy shrews endangered?
- 53) Are pygmy shrews good climbers?



Pygmy Shrew

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	D	26.	opinion	51.	declarative
2.	B	27.	fact	52.	interrogative
3.	D	28.	opinion	53.	interrogative
4.	A	29.	fact		
5.	C	30.	fact		
6.	A	31.	opinion		
7.	B	32.	opinion		
8.	B	33.	true		
9.	B	34.	false		
10.	D	35.	true		
11.	Not	36.	false		
12.	Would	37.	true		
13.	Would	38.	false		
14.	Would	39.	false		
15.	Not	40.	false		
16.	Not	41.	true		
17.	Not	42.	true		
18.	Not	43.	B		
19.	Not	44.	A		
20.	Would	45.	D		
21.	Not	46.	A		
22.	Would	47.	C		
23.	fact	48.	declarative		
24.	opinion	49.	interrogative		
25.	fact	50.	declarative		